

Deans' Handbook

Rhythm Games Academy

1 October 2026

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This English version is a reference translation. In the event of any discrepancy, the Japanese version prevails.

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Chapter 1 General Decision-Making

1.1 Status of this Handbook

This Handbook is a guideline setting out how Deans carry out their work, based on Chapter 1, Article 5 and Chapter 5, Article 1, paragraph 2 of the Academy Regulations. Give priority to the Academy Charter and the Academy Regulations; do not use this Handbook alone to impose new obligations on Students. If a passage conflicts with the Regulations or an announced practice, check the higher-ranking document and discuss a correction with the other Deans.

1.2 Principles of the Role

Deans support an environment in which Students can continue their inquiry activities (Chapter 5 of the Academy Regulations). Treat Students as equal members, and do not judge the relative merits of activities by their subject, the person's experience, or their achievements. Intervene in Students' activities only where grounds specified in the Regulations exist, and only to the minimum extent necessary. When several means are available, choose those that are less restrictive and easier to reverse or recover from. For decisions affecting rights or interests, make the grounds and established facts clear so that you can explain the reasons to the person concerned. Record decisions and procedures so that a successor can take over the work.

1.3 Decision Procedure and Consultation

When asked to act, check the applicable Charter and Regulations provisions, announced guidance, and decisions in similar cases. If facts are missing, ask for further information. Unless the situation is urgent, explain that you will respond after checking. The Dean responsible may handle routine administrative work. Before reaching a conclusion, however, share with the other Deans any decision affecting Students' rights or interests, any decision without precedent, or any decision that will become a standard for the Academy's operation.

1.4 Explanation, Records, and Handover

The person making a decision records its subject, the established facts, the applicable provisions, the people consulted, the conclusion, and communications with the person concerned and their timing. Do not finalize a decision affecting rights or interests solely through mechanical processing; the person responsible must be able to explain the reasons. Keep only information needed for the work and do not share records with people who are not involved. When responsibility changes, hand over unfinished matters and the reasons for decisions to the successor.

Chapter 2 Joining the Academy and Continuing Membership

2.1 Starting Recruitment

Deans check the recruitment periods in Chapter 3, Article 3 and the provisions of Chapter 4, Article 3 of the Academy Regulations, and announce how applications are accepted. If operational needs require a limit on the number of new Students, announce the limit and application method before accepting applications. The limit applies to new admissions during that recruitment period; it is not a limit on total membership or the duration of existing Students' membership.

2.2 When the Limit Is Reached

When the limit is reached, close acceptance of new applications and promptly announce the closure and its timing. For inquiries after closure, explain that applications are not currently being accepted and provide only information already decided about the next recruitment period.

2.3 Withdrawal and Loss of Status

Students continue their membership without applying again each academic term and may leave at any time (Chapter 4, Articles 5 and 6 of the Regulations). On receiving a request to withdraw, the person responsible confirms the person's identity and the relevant records, and records how the withdrawal is handled and any necessary communications. Loss of status through expulsion follows the disciplinary procedures in Chapter 8 of the Regulations. Do not deprive an existing Student of their status because of admission numbers or how often they participate.

Chapter 3 Applications to Become a Lecturer or Open a Course

3.1 Receiving an Application to Become a Lecturer

Check for a basis in knowledge or experience that the applicant can share with other Students in their proposed field, but do not make competitive results, years of experience, or completion of the achievements field a universal requirement. If the proposed field is narrow, you may suggest broadening it as an option, but do not make this a condition of approval.

3.2 Receiving an Application to Open a Course

The person responsible checks that the applicant is a Lecturer, that the required application information is present, that course information is provided, and whether there are any conditions for taking the course. As a general rule, handle complete applications with a view to approval so that Lecturers can carry out their activities. Under Chapter 7, Article 5 of the Academy Regulations, Faculties and course categories are guides for finding courses. For a course spanning several categories, selecting the principal category is sufficient; suggest a different category as advice. Do not refuse approval solely because a topic is unusual, narrow, or overlaps an existing course. The number of sessions is the Lecturer's plan, and the content, structure, and conduct of the course are at the Lecturer's discretion (Chapter 6, Article 3 of the Regulations). Explain the make-up period provisions in Chapter 7, Article 9 of the Regulations for sessions that are difficult to conduct as planned.

3.3 Corrections, Approval, and Notification of the Result

If information is missing or facts are uncertain, the person responsible checks with the applicant and explains specifically what can be corrected. The grounds for asking a Lecturer to discontinue or change a course under Chapter 7, Article 10 of the Academy Regulations do not directly establish criteria for approving course applications. Do not mechanically use those grounds alone to refuse an application. Share the corrected materials and the grounds for the decision with the Deans. Approval of Lecturer applications and course applications both requires unanimous agreement of the Deans, under Chapter 6, Article 2, paragraph 2 and

Chapter 7, Article 6, paragraph 2 of the Regulations, respectively. Do not substitute a decision by the Director alone for that approval.

Notify the applicant of the result. If approval is refused, state the established facts and reasons (Chapter 5, Article 6, paragraph 2 of the Regulations). The person responsible records the application, requests for corrections, each Dean's judgment, the conclusion, and communications. If the applicant asks for the reasons to be checked again or for reconsideration, discuss the request among the Deans.

Chapter 4 Course Registration and Participation Records

4.1 Preparing the Form and Response Sheet

For the time being, course registration is accepted through a separate Google Form for each course that requires registration. The Dean responsible copies the Academy's template and, in consultation with the Lecturer, sets the course name, a display of or link to the syllabus, any conditions for taking the course, and contact details for changes and cancellation. Limit response fields to information necessary to manage participation. Set a Google Sheets spreadsheet dedicated to that course as the destination for responses and give the Lecturer responsible the editing permissions needed to enter records and assessments. Before announcing that registration is open, check the form's display, the destination of responses, and the spreadsheet's sharing settings with the Lecturer.

4.2 When Registration Takes Effect and Checking Conditions

Course registration takes effect when a Student submits the required information through the course's form and the form accepts the response. If the Lecturer sets conditions for taking the course, display them in the form's instructions so that Students can check them before submitting, in accordance with Chapter 7, Article 7, paragraph 2 of the Academy Regulations. The Lecturer checks registrations in the course's response sheet. If omissions, duplicate entries, or a failure to meet the conditions are found, check with the person concerned, explain how the matter will be handled, and record the action taken. When a Lecturer seeks advice, the Dean checks the registration record and the conditions that were communicated, and provides support. Do not treat a failure to meet course conditions as a loss of Student or Lecturer status.

4.3 Changes, Cancellation, and Corrections

Requests to change or cancel a registration go to the Lecturer responsible; tell Students how to contact that Lecturer. The Lecturer confirms the registration concerned and the person's request, records the status, such as "taking the course" or "cancelled", and the changes and other relevant details in the response sheet, and informs the person of the result. Correct errors

such as a mistaken Student ID after checking with the person concerned. If a Dean receives a request, pass it to the Lecturer and provide support as needed.

4.4 Assessment Records and Permitted Uses

The Lecturer may record participation and assessments within the course in its response sheet. Use records only to identify participants, change or cancel registrations, communicate as necessary to run the course, and enable the Lecturer responsible to record participation and assessments. Do not reuse them as lists for other courses or for purposes outside the Academy. Assessment records kept by a Lecturer do not constitute the Academy's formal recognition of grades or credits. Full operation of the grades and credits system is planned for the next academic term or later.

4.5 Retention, Permissions, and Handover

Access to the response sheet is limited to the Lecturer responsible and Deans who need it for administrative work. The Dean responsible checks sharing settings and, when the course ends, reviews the need to retain records with the Lecturer and removes unnecessary copies and sharing permissions. No uniform retention period or deletion schedule has yet been established. Before deleting individual records, discuss their handling among the Deans and record the decision. When the Lecturer or Dean responsible changes, hand over pending changes and corrections, the location of records, and the necessary viewing and editing permissions to the successor. Remove permissions that are no longer needed after the handover.

Chapter 5 Maintaining Order, Removal from Office, and Disciplinary Measures

5.1 Receiving a Consultation or Learning of a Problem

The person responsible checks relevant posts or requests, their content and timing, and the accounts of the people involved. Confirm the wishes of someone who seeks advice only. Unless harm is imminent, do not establish a violation on one person's account alone. When referring to announced community rules, check their wording and the circumstances in which they apply. Do not treat requests such as taking care with spoilers or choosing roles as grounds for discipline under Chapter 8, Article 4 of the Academy Regulations solely on that basis. When considering disciplinary measures, identify specifically which ground in that Article applies.

5.2 Ordinary Responses and Disciplinary Measures

Once a problem has been confirmed, the person responsible considers whether contacting those involved or correcting facts will resolve it, and shares the matter with the other Deans as needed. When imposing a disciplinary measure, check the person's account and record separately the facts falling under Chapter 8, Article 4 of the Academy Regulations and the type of measure under Article 5. As a general rule, measures progress from warning to suspension of activities to expulsion. Apply Article 6 to a further violation in the same term after a warning, or during or after suspension. Suspension of activities or expulsion without a prior warning is permitted only for an exceptionally serious violation under Article 7. Inform the person of the established facts, grounds, disciplinary measure, its duration if applicable, and where to submit an appeal. The person responsible records who participated in the decision, the notification, and the start and end times.

5.3 Emergency Measures

When harm to order or Student safety is occurring or imminent, temporary access restrictions or other measures may be taken to the extent necessary under Chapter 8, Article 8 of the Academy Regulations. The person responsible records the scope and start time of the measure, notifies the person concerned of the reasons without delay, and shares the information with the

other Deans. The measure ceases to have effect no later than the last day of the academic term concerned. Because this is not a disciplinary measure, assess separately under that chapter whether discipline is needed if a continuing restriction is necessary.

5.4 Resignation, Removal from Office, and Appeals

Officeholders other than the Director notify the Director of resignation; the Director notifies the Deans (Chapter 8, Article 2 of the Regulations). For removal from office, check the grounds in Article 3. For an officeholder other than the Director, the Director makes the decision after consultation among the Deans; for the Director, the Deans decide through consultation. Removal from office is not a disciplinary measure against the person as a Student. Consider discipline separately if necessary. Inform the person of the removal and its reasons, and record the decision-maker and the handover of duties.

When receiving an appeal against removal from office, an emergency measure, or a disciplinary measure, Deans other than those who made the original decision review it under Chapter 8, Article 9 of the Regulations. The reviewers check the facts, applicable provisions, and necessity of the measure, then inform the appellant of the conclusion and reasons and record them. Handle requests to reconsider refusal of an application under Chapter 3 of this Handbook, separately from this appeal process.

Chapter 6 Inquiries and Consultations

6.1 Receiving an Inquiry

When receiving an inquiry through the Academy's communication channels or an announced external contact point, the person responsible checks what the person wants to know, when a response is needed, and whether any circumstances concern Student safety. Respond to inquiries from people who are not Students within the scope of information that can be disclosed. For a consultation, check whether the person only wants an answer or is asking for action or to report a problem. If imminent harm is suspected, consider the emergency measures in Chapter 5 of this Handbook.

6.2 Responses and Handover

When explaining an established system, point to the relevant Regulations or announced guidance. For undecided matters, such as numbers, application dates, or the Academy's formal grades and credits system, say that they are undecided. Do not promise the outcome of an application or disciplinary decision in advance. If you cannot decide alone, explain that you will check and follow up. Pass the main points of the inquiry and what you have already said to the other Deans. For answers interpreting the system or setting a precedent, record the grounds, the person who responded, and the time of the communication.

6.3 Questions about Copyrighted Works

Discussing a work, posting audio or images, using such material in course materials, and publishing course materials outside the Academy involve different actions and different scopes of disclosure. Confirm which action the person is asking about and advise them to check the material's rights holder, terms of use, permission, or applicable legal basis. Do not promise that citing a source permits every use of the material. For use within the Academy of course materials created by a Lecturer, check the scope of Chapter 6, Article 2 and Chapter 7, Article 8 of the Academy Regulations. Do not assume that permission to publish outside the Academy

has been granted. If judgment is difficult, avoid a definitive answer, record what needs to be checked, and share it among the Deans.

Chapter 7 Official Materials, Amendments, and Announcements

7.1 Preparing Guidance

The person responsible checks the current Academy Charter, Academy Regulations, and announced guidance for the systems and practices described in the material. Do not describe numbers under consideration or systems planned for the next academic term as already decided or implemented. State the material's intended audience, update date, and references. Before publication, check provision references, the presence of personal information, and wording with another Dean. This check is to confirm accuracy; it does not add an approval procedure absent from the Regulations.

7.2 Amending Regulations or Guidelines

Follow Chapter 9 of the Academy Regulations when amending the Regulations. Distinguish the proposal by a Dean, its taking effect through advance notification to the other Deans, and the Director's prompt announcement to Students. Seek Students' views as necessary. Under Chapter 1, Article 5 of the Regulations, guidelines must comply with the Charter and Regulations and must not create Student obligations absent from the Regulations. Promptly announce the adoption, amendment, or repeal of guidelines concerning Students' activities. Do not treat editing source files or sharing a draft as completion of these procedures or announcements.

7.3 Checks and Records after a Change

The person responsible records the changes, grounds, timing of advance notifications and announcements, and related guidance updated. When changing guidance, check application forms, the official website, pinned posts within the Academy, and other relevant locations for outdated explanations, and pass necessary corrections to the people responsible. Make clear the reasons for changes and communications to affected Students, and continue to identify undecided matters as undecided.

Chapter 8 Activity Environment and Handover of Responsibilities

8.1 Changing Spaces or Permissions

Before establishing a new space, the person responsible determines and communicates its purpose, intended users, and who will manage it. When reorganizing an existing space, check Students' usage and activity records that should be retained, and tell affected people what will change and when. Grant viewing and editing permissions only to the extent needed for the work. Do not treat the technical permissions of an office as a hierarchy among Students. Do not create prohibitions or grounds for discipline absent from the Regulations merely through a space's instructions.

8.2 Checking Settings and Automation

The person who changes a setting records its purpose, the change, the behavior checked, and how to reverse it. Repetitive administrative work may be automated, but do not finalize conclusions affecting Student status, approval, discipline, or other rights or interests solely from automated processing. The Dean responsible must know the contact point and correction procedure for unintended results.

8.3 Handover of Responsibilities

The outgoing person tells their successor about ongoing applications and inquiries, reasons for decisions, announced guidance, space settings, and the location of records. The successor checks whether the transferred permissions allow them to perform the necessary work and removes the predecessor's permissions that are no longer needed. Hand over course registration forms and response sheets using the procedures in Chapter 4 of this Handbook. Do not treat undecided matters discovered during handover as institutional decisions solely because they were the predecessor's customary practice.

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History

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